

PASSWITHPURPOSE

NEW
2027
FORMAT

CAMBRIDGE IGCSE • FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH • 0500

Revision *Flashcards*

32 printable revision cards covering every question on both papers: the method, the forms, the techniques, the command words and the timing.

- ◆ 10 Paper 1 method cards
- ◆ 4 composition cards
- ◆ 2 command word cards
- ◆ 2 top-mistakes cards
- ◆ 7 Paper 2 Section A cards
- ◆ 5 language technique cards
- ◆ 2 timing cards
- ◆ Colour-coded by topic

Marcé van Moerkerken

PGCE Secondary English (Summa Cum Laude)
International school English teacher, UAE

For exams in 2027, 2028 and 2029. Independent revision material; not produced or endorsed by Cambridge University Press & Assessment.

How to use these cards

Print pages 2–5 on card or thick paper (A4, 100% scale) and cut along the dashed lines. Each page holds eight cards.

Colour	Topic	Cards
 Navy	Paper 1 Reading methods	10
 Gold	Paper 2 Section A: directed writing	7
 Green	Paper 2 Section B: composition	4
 Red	Language techniques and explaining effect	5
 Grey	Command words, timing and top mistakes	6

Five ways to revise with them

Cover and recall	Read the title, cover the card, say the method aloud, then check.
Pair quiz	A partner reads a title; you explain it in 30 seconds.
Before every practice question	Pull out the card for that question and follow it step by step.
Exam week	Read the timing and top-mistakes cards the night before each paper.
Classroom	Display the set as a wall, or use one card as a lesson starter.

FOR TEACHERS: Your licence covers printing a set for each student in your class.

PAPER 1

Paper 1 at a glance

- 2 hours · 80 marks · 3 texts (A, B, C)
- Q1 Text A · 20 marks
- Q2 Text B · 15 + 5 marks
- Q3 Text C · 10 + 10 marks
- Q4 Text C · 20 marks
- Read all texts first: 15 min

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PAPER 1

Q1 Comprehension

- **Find** the key word, then locate the lines
- **Prove:** for “suggest”, say what the detail *shows*
- **Phrase** in your own words
- One clear point per mark
- Questions follow the order of the text

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PAPER 1

Says or suggests?

- **SAYS** (explicit): give, identify, what does the writer tell us
- → precise, no commentary
- **SUGGESTS** (implicit): suggest, explain how, what does this show
- → inference + anchor it to a detail

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PAPER 1

Q2(a) Summary: 5 steps

- 1 Lock the focus as a heading
- 2 Number every relevant point
- 3 Group points under umbrella words
- 4 Write 100–115 words of continuous prose
- 5 Count words; cross out copied phrases

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PAPER 1

Q2(a) Summary: rules

- ✓ Own words ✓ Connectives
- ✓ Cover the whole text ✓ Third person
- ✗ Examples and statistics (unless they are the point)
- ✗ Bullet points ✗ Opinions
- ✗ More than 120 words

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PAPER 1

Q2(b) Attitudes · 5 marks

- Attitude + evidence + explanation
- “The writer is *critical* of....: calling it ‘baffling’ shows...”
- Useful attitude words: admiring, critical, sympathetic, sceptical, hopeful, dismissive

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PAPER 1

Q3 Word meanings · 2 marks

- Read the whole sentence + the one before
- Write a precise meaning for *this* context
- **Swap test:** put it back in the sentence
- Vague one-word answers risk losing a mark

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PAPER 1

Q3 Language task

- 200–250 words · 10 marks
- **Choose** 3–4 short choices per paragraph
- **Zoom:** literal meaning → connotations
- **Connect:** effect on the reader and why
- Never “vivid imagery” without explaining it

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PAPER 1

Q4 Extended response

- 250–300 words · 10R + 10W
- **Mine** details for every bullet
- **Stretch**: develop and infer
- **Voice**: right person, form, audience
- Plan in 3 columns, one per bullet

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PAPER 1

Q4 forms

- Letter: greeting, purpose, sign-off
- Report: title, subheadings, recommendations
- Journal: first person, date, reflection
- Speech: address audience, strong close
- Interview: speaker labels · Article: headline

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PAPER 2 · SECTION A

Paper 2 at a glance

- 2 hours · 80 marks
- Section A: 1(a) 5 marks + 1(b) 35 marks
- Texts: 550–650 words
- Section B composition: 40 marks
- 350–450 words, 1 of 4 titles

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PAPER 2 · SECTION A

1(a) Structured question

- Name the technique or claim precisely
- Quote briefly
- Explain the effect on the reader
- or judge how convincing it is
- Keep it short: 5 marks only

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PAPER 2 · SECTION A

1(b) Directed writing: 5 steps

- 1 Decode: form, audience, purpose, position
- 2 Map: agree / disagree / “yes, but...”
- 3 Evaluate: reliable? biased? missing?
- 4 Plan 4–5 paragraphs
- 5 Write 250–350 words; proofread

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PAPER 2 · SECTION A

Repeat → Evaluate

- **Repeat**: “The text says...”
- **Use**: put the idea in your argument
- **Develop**: “This matters because...”
- **Evaluate**: “However, the evidence...”
- Evaluation lifts the reading marks

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PAPER 2 · SECTION A

Questioning evidence

- Statistic with no source?
- Only one example or story?
- Small or one-sided survey?
- Do the texts contradict each other?
- What has the writer left out?

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PAPER 2 · SECTION A

Speech & article

- **Speech**: greet the audience, hook, “we”, direct address, memorable close, thanks
- **Article**: headline, attention-grabbing opening, lively paragraphs, strong final line

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Letter & report

- **Letter:** "Dear...", purpose in paragraph 1, polite call to action, "Yours sincerely/faithfully"
- **Report:** title, purpose, subheadings, balanced findings, numbered recommendations, no emotive language

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Descriptive: structure

- 1 Wide view: place, time, mood
- 2 Zoom in on one detail
- 3 A person or movement
- 4 A shift: time, weather, light
- 5 Return to the wide view, changed

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Descriptive: do & don't

- ✓ All five senses, specific
- ✓ One controlling image
- ✓ One-line paragraph for impact
- ✗ Plot creep ✗ Clichés
- ✗ "I could see... I could hear..."

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Narrative: story mountain

- 1 Hook in the middle of the action
- 2 Context: who, where, what they want
- 3 Complication
- 4 Climax: slow down here
- 5 Resolution: show the change

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Narrative: do & don't

- ✓ One event, 2–3 characters
- ✓ Show, don't tell
- ✓ A returning object
- ✗ "It was all a dream"
- ✗ Rushed endings

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Imagery

- **Simile:** comparison with like/as
- **Metaphor:** says one thing is another
- **Personification:** human qualities to things
- Always explain the *picture* and *why*

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Words and sounds

- **Connotation:** the feelings a word carries
- **Onomatopoeia:** word sounds like its meaning
- **Alliteration / sibilance:** repeated sounds
- Link the sound to the mood

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Structure and contrast

- **Juxtaposition:** opposites placed together
- **Short sentence:** impact, shock, finality
- **List:** abundance, chaos, build-up
- **Pathetic fallacy:** weather mirrors mood

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LANGUAGE

Persuasive devices

- Direct address ("you")
- Rule of three
- Rhetorical question
- Statistic or expert
- Counter-argument + rebuttal
- Emotive language

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LANGUAGE

Explaining effect

- "...suggests that..."
- "...carries connotations of..."
- "...implies..."
- "...so the reader feels..."
- "...emphasising how..."
- "...creating a sense of..."

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EXAM TECHNIQUE

Command words (1)

- **Analyse:** examine how the parts work
- **Evaluate:** judge quality or value
- **Explain:** give reasons, how or why
- **Identify:** name it, briefly

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EXAM TECHNIQUE

Command words (2)

- **Give:** produce an answer from the text
- **Describe:** state the main features
- **Suggest:** a reasonable idea
- **Justify:** support with evidence

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EXAM TECHNIQUE

Paper 1 timing

- Read all texts: 15 min
- Q1: 20 min
- Q2: 25 min
- Q3: 25 min
- Q4: 30 min
- Check: 5 min

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EXAM TECHNIQUE

Paper 2 timing

- Read texts + 1(a): 15 min
- Plan 1(b): 8 min
- Write 1(b): 35 min
- Plan composition: 10 min
- Write composition: 45 min
- Check: 7 min

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EXAM TECHNIQUE

Top mistakes (1)

- Copying phrases from the text
- Ignoring a Q4 bullet
- Adding ideas not in the text
- Naming techniques without explaining
- Poor timing

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EXAM TECHNIQUE

Top mistakes (2)

- Examples in the summary
- Repeating texts in directed writing
- A story for a descriptive title
- Word meanings that don't fit
- Slipping tenses; careless punctuation

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NEXT STEP

Practise what the cards teach

The cards give students the method. The PassWithPurpose packs give them the practice: original texts, full question papers, mark schemes and model answers for the new 2027 format.

Complete Exam Guide	Every question explained, with worked examples
Paper 1 Practice Pack	Three full Paper 1 practice papers
Paper 2 Directed Writing Pack	Four Section A tasks with model answers
Composition Pack	Toolkits, 20 titles and four model compositions

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